

Directing

***Directing is a key
managerial function***



DIRECTING

Introduction:

- Directing is a management function which plays a pivotal role in ensuring that organizational plans are put into action through directing the work of subordinates by the managers. It encourages leadership, motivation, and communication techniques and emphasizes the human aspects of managing individuals and teams to carry out tasks and activities in alignment with the organization's overall strategy
- Directing is the initiation and maintenance of action toward the desired objectives which can be fostered by nursing administrators who desire to improve their directing activities. It is the process of applying the management plans to accomplish nursing objectives through telling subordinates what to do, so the manager must ensure that the subordinates know what to do, how to do, when to do and why they do it.

Definition of directing:

Directing is a crucial component of the management process of guiding, supervising, and influencing employees and resources within an organization to achieve its goals and objectives effectively and efficiently.

Purpose of directing:

To channel the behavior of all personnel to accomplish the organizations mission and objectives and helping them accomplish their own career objectives.

Importance of directing:

- Effective directing increases subordinates contributions to achievement of nursing management goals.
- Effective directing creates harmony between nursing management goals and nursing workers goals.
- Effective directing is the management functions where in the nurse manager acts as a facilitator and coach.

Elements of directing:**1- Supervision:**

- Supervision involves providing guidance and direction to the work in order to achieve a certain purpose.

2- Leadership:

- Leadership plays an important role in directing, as it refer to influence others in a manner to do what the leader wants them to do. Leadership is about getting

people to understand and believe in the leader vision and to work with him to achieve his goals.



3-Motivation:

- **Motivation is forces that inspire a person at work to intensify his willingness to use the best of his capability for achievement of specific objectives. Motivation refers to that process which excites people to work for attainment of the desired objective.**

- **It may be in the form of incentives like financial (such as bonus, commission etc.) or, non-financial (such as appreciation, growth etc.), or it could be positive or negative.**

Application of directing by the nurse manager:

1-Whatever the management level, the nurse manager apply directing through the following points according to their span of control.

2- Lead the nursing personnel by using suitable leadership style.

3- Act as a role model.

4-Delegate authority down the line of the nursing hierarchy.

5-Supervise the nursing personnel during their work.

6- Create the environment that is conducive to work.

7- Use the method of assignment that appropriate to the patients' numbers, acuity level, and the nurses' competency level.

8- Supervise the communication flow in the organization.

9- Create a defined communication channels.

10- Resolve the nurses' conflict through using appropriate mechanism.

11- Create the learning experience that helps to improve the nurse performance.



Introduction:

Controlling is one of the most basic functions of management, like planning, organizing, staffing, etc. Controlling is an important function, and without controlling management can't ensure the desired results.

Definition of controlling:

Controlling is the process of monitoring activities to ensure that they are being accomplished as planned and correcting any significant variations.

Importance of controlling:

- 1. Controlling motivates employees**
- 2. Controlling makes the efficient use of resources**
- 3. Controlling ensures coordination of action.**
- 4. Controlling helps in deciding the right judgment about the standards**
- 5. Controlling aids in the accomplishment of organizational goals**
- 6. Controlling helps in improving the performance of the employees**
- 7. Controlling helps in minimizing the errors**

Process of controlling:

1-Establishing standards:

This means setting up of the target which needs to be achieved to meet organizational goals eventually. Standards indicate the criteria of performance. Standards can be set in both quantitative as well as qualitative terms. It is important that standards should be flexible enough to be modified whenever required. Standards should be **SMART** as:

S-Simply Expressed

M-Measurable

A- Attainable

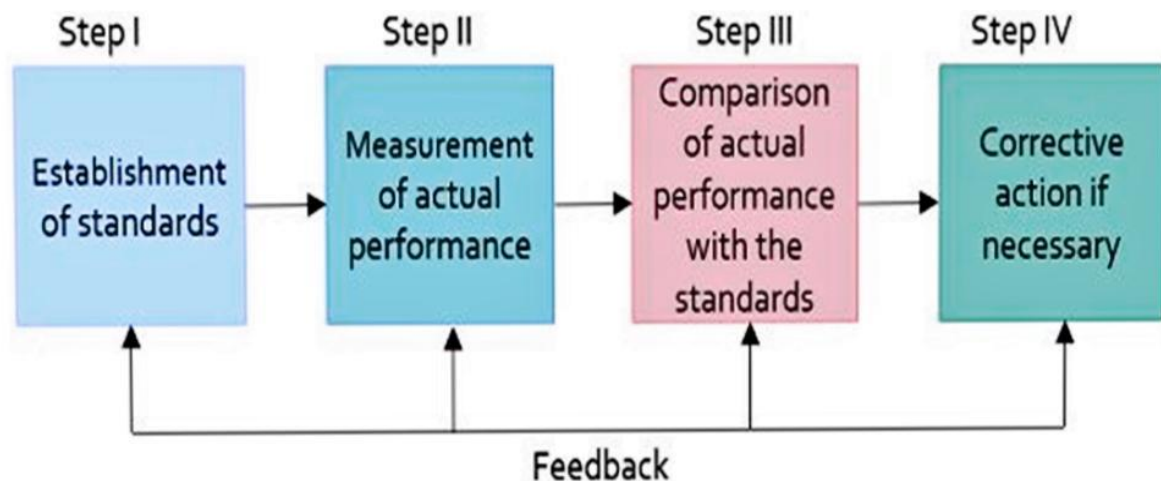
R- Reasonable

T-Time bounded

2-Measuring actual performance:

- Managers must measure actual performance to determine any variations from standard.
- Three common sources of information frequently used by managers to measure

actual performance:



1. Personal observation

2. Oral reports

3. Written reports

- The actual performance of the employee is measured against the target. With the increasing levels of management, the measurement of performance becomes difficult.

3-Comparing measured performance to established standards:

A third step asks the manager to compare the measurement against the standard.

A- This is an application asking a comparison between the what is and the what should be.

B- If the comparison results or measurements are acceptable, no action needs to be taken. If results show a trend away from the acceptable or show the unacceptable, action may be called for. The difference between what is and what should be is known as the deviation.

4-Taking corrective actions:

- It is initiated by the manager who corrects any defects in actual performance. Controlling process regulates organization's activities, so that actual performance conforms to the standard plan. An effective control system enables managers to avoid circumstances which cause the organization's loss.

- The last step, taking corrective action, depends on three things: the standard,

the accuracy of the measurements that determined a deviation exists, and the diagnosis of the person or device investigating the cause for the deviation.

- Corrective actions can be prescribed by management in advance through policies, procedures, and practices Some corrective actions may be automatic Some corrective actions may have to take exception to established policy, procedure, or practices.

Examples of such corrective action might include:

- Changing strategy.
- Changing structure.
- Training programs
- Redesigning jobs.
- Firing employees.

Types of controlling:

1-Feedback Control:

This process involves collecting information about a finished task, assessing that information and improvising the same type of tasks in the future.

- These post-performance controls focus upon the end results of the process. The information obtained is used for corrective purposes. Adjustments and/or corrections follow the feedback input.

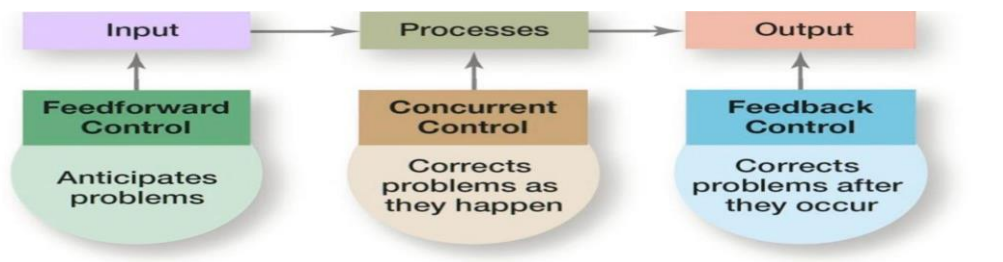
2-Concurrent control:

It is also called real-time control, in-process" or "steering controls. It checks any problem and examines it to take action before any loss is incurred.

3-Predictive/feed forward control:

- This type of control helps to foresee problem ahead of occurrence. Therefore, action can be taken before such a circumstance arises.
- In an ever-changing and complex environment, controlling forms an integral part of the organization.
- It is future directed: they are designed to detect and anticipate deviations from standards at various points. Such preventative controls focus on establishing conditions that will make it difficult or impossible for deviations from norms to

occur. Examples include job descriptions, job specifications, inductions, and orientation.



Control Systems:

The composite Feedback, Concurrent, and feed forward control make up a "package" or "system." A system is a combination of any two or more controls.

Characteristics of effective control system:

1. **Suitable:** The control system must be suitable to the needs of an organization.
2. **Simple:** The control system should be easy to understand and operate.
3. **Economic feasibility:** compares the costs to the benefits.
4. **Accuracy:** The information for the control must be useful and accurate.
5. **Forward Looking:** control system should be forward looking. It must provide timely information on deviations.

Methods of controlling:

1-Direct Supervision and Observation:

It is the oldest method of controlling. The supervisor himself observes the employees and their work. This brings him in direct contact with the workers.

2-Financial Statements:

All organizations prepare profit and loss account. It gives a summary of the income and expenses for a specified period. They also prepare balance sheet, which shows the financial position of the organization at the end of the specified period. Financial statements are used to control the organization.

3- Management by Objectives (MBO):

MBO facilitates planning and control. It must fulfill following requirements objectives for individuals are jointly fixed by the superior and the subordinate.

Periodic evaluation and regular feedback to evaluate individual performance.
Achievement of objectives brings rewards to individuals

4-Self-Control:

Self-Control means self-directed control. A person is given freedom to set his own targets, evaluate his own performance and take corrective measures as and when required. Self-control is especially required for top level managers because they do not like external control.

Role of nurse manager for controlling:

- 1-Gave an employee a job performance evaluation.
2. Encourages followers to be actively involved in the control process.
3. Clearly communication expected standards of care to subordinator.
4. Uses control as a method of determining why goals were not met.
5. Support/actively participates in research efforts to identify and measure.
6. Accesses appropriate sources of information in data gathering for control.
7. Is politically active in communicating control.

Staffing



Definition of Staffing:

- Staffing is the process of ascertaining that adequate numbers and an appropriate mix of personnel are available to meet daily unit needs and organizational goals.
- It is the process of determining and assigning the right personnel with the right qualifications to the job in a right time to accomplish the purposes of the organization.



Goals of staffing:

- Appropriate numbers and mix of nursing staff
- Delivery of effective and efficient nursing care
- Increase productivity
- Avoid role confusion, communication problems and time waste
- Maintain stability in team work
- Provide each nursing unit with an appropriate number of each category of worker to perform the nursing tasks required to give care and comfort to patients in the unit.

Factors affecting staffing:

1. Patient factors:

- Patient type (age , sex, diagnosis)
- Length of stay
- Complexity of care

2. Staff factors :

- Personnel policies (vacation , overtime, part time, work)
- Educational and experiential levels of staff

3. Environmental factors :

- Number of patients' beds
- Availability of supplies and equipment

Methods of calculating staffing:

1. **Patient classification system:**

- It is system developed to objectively determine workload requirements and staffing needs

2. **Diagnostic related groups:**

- Based on the medical diagnosis of the patients

3. **Acuity and complexity of care:**

- Estimate how many hours of nursing care will be needed during a particular shift.

4. **Staffing formulas:**

- Must consider hours which coverage is required, vacations, holidays, absenteeism, and staff development time.

Manpower planning:

Manpower planning may be defined as a strategy for the acquisition, utilization, improvement and preservation of the human resources of an organization. This involves ensuring that organization has enough of the right kind of people at the right time and also adjusting the requirements to the available supply.

The main objectives of manpower planning:

1. Ensuring maximum utilization of the personnel
2. Assessing future requirements of the organization
3. Determining the recruitment sources.
4. Determining training requirements for management's development and organizational development.

Nursing Staffing Guidelines:

- **Provide an all-professional nurse staff in critical care units, operating rooms, labor and emergency room.**
- **Provide sufficient staff to permit a 1:1 nurse- patient ratio for each shift in every critical care unit**
- **Staff the general medical, surgical, obstetrics and gynecology, pediatrics and Psychiatric units to achieve a 2:1 professional-practical nurse ratio.**
- **Provide sufficient nursing staff in general, medical, surgical, obstetrics and gynecology, pediatric and psychiatric units to permit a 1:5 nurse patient ratio on a day and afternoon shifts and 1:10 nurse patient ratio on night shift.**
- **Involve the heads of the nursing staffs and all nursing personnel in designing the department's overall staffing program.**
- **Post time schedules for all personnel at least eight weeks in advance.**
- **Reward employees for long term service by granting individuals special time requests on the basis of seniority.**